Ros Bandt
The Australian Centre
The University of Melbourne
137 Barry St,
Carlton, Vic, 3055
Australia
Email: r.bandt@unimelb.edu.au

From Bridges to BYOS: 10 years of Global and local electro-acoustic collaborations by Ros Bandt (Australia), with Johannes S. Sistermanns (Germany)

Artist Talk

Abstract

This paper traces the relationships of place, culture and identity in the shared electro-acoustic collaborations by Ros Bandt (Australia) and Johannes S. Sistermanns (Germany) over a ten year period. Two works A Global Bridge for Percy *for the Melbourne International festival in 1997 and the recent* BYOS, bring your own sounds, *2006, a collaborative work co-composed in the Melbourne studios of the ABC provide a platform for discussion of the collaborative process involving various degrees of freedom and control and decision making by both electro-acoustic composer performers*

Introduction

This artist talk considers the ten years of electroacoustic composition in relation to two collaborative works spanning the ten year period 1997-2006. It investigates the local worlds of both composer performers and sound artists, the Australian Ros Bandt and the German Johannes S. Sistermanns who met in Australia at the Transit Zeitglieich festival in 1993. They have shared their independent soundart practices in Australia, and Germany, performed in each others territory, and globally in the digital realtime broadcasting of works performed in the different nations and heard across the world in realtime, from Melbourne's Percy Grainger Museum to the Frankfurter Hochschule for Musicwissenschaft und Darstelle Kunst. The digital documentation of these works is a postscript of these visceral and virtual events.
http://www.abc.net.au/arts/lroom/globgar.htm

Bandt,(Sounding Spaces) and Sistermanns, (Soundplastic) have shared their local domains and ability to transcend and transform these through their international co-operative ventures. Sound Installation, soundplastic, performance and electroacoustic composition are components of the wider philosophical and artistic aims of each project, one Global, spanning Frankfurt and Melbourne in real time,
http://www.abc.net.au/arts/lroom/gardel.htm
from Melbourne's Percy Grainger museum to the Musikhochschule Frankfurt where Grainger studied , the other an intense 3 days in the ABC Melbourne studios with an engineer, each artist providing sonic material unseen by the other to share.

For each work Ros Bandt provides a graphic cartography of sound files, dense processes and temporal designs involved including flow diagrams, spatial mapping and scores. Both works were commissioned and recorded by the ABC. *A Global Bridge for Percy* is 50 minutes and can be heard on the above website, while *BYOS*, 16 minutes, a radiophonic work will be broadcast by ABC's New Music Uplate shortly. and can be heard in the audiotech here at the ACMA conference. Audible statements from each composer have been commissioned by Robyn Ravlich from audio arts about the process of BYOS and these will be broadcast as part of the programme.

Questions are posed, How do you share the concept of a work? Who does what and when? How do you agree on the many levelled sonic parameters for each sound and the more formal flow and morphology of events? What is the role of the technician/s in relation to the artistic directors? In what sense is the outcome of BYOS and Bridges a collaborative work? Who owns it?

How do the different cultures affect the possibilities of artistic creation? How is aesthetic collaboration arrived at?

The author is pursuing these questions in the future against a range of cultures as she leaves for Turkey later this year as the Tarhu nomad to investigate live electronics using audio mulch with Erdem Helvacioglu.

References

Bandt, Ros. 2001. "A Global Bridge for Percy", *Sound Sculpture: Intersections in Sound and Sculpture in Australian Artworks*, Craftsman House, pp132-140. Also see CD track 30

The cross cultural bowed spike fiddle:Tarhu
www.spikefiddle.com